

that only that layer is visible and what's worse is that you might notice that the video doesn't just play the cropped version but the whole version. There's nothing to worry about here as you've just opened a layer in a separate tab by accident. You can simply close this tab by clicking the x in the top left of the composition panel (the first tab is the composition tab by default, so you'll be closing the second tab)

A very interesting observation here is that, no matter which video you trim, the video doesn't actually get trimmed (as mentioned earlier), you will see that the supposedly trimmed part is highlighted in the time bar and the rest of the time bar of that element is just dimmed out. This means that none of the unused video is actually discarded, it's just not in the foreground. So, if by chance you decide to make a few changes to one of the layers, it's right there!

Once you add on layers or videos, you can just drag the active time bar to see if the video actually switches the way you want it to, you don't have to RAM preview every time. During the integration process, even if you want to RAM preview, you can do it at a lower resolution and once the final piece is ready, you can RAM preview at full resolution!

TIME STRETCHING

There are certain times when we may need to speed up or slow down animation sequences. Doing this with animations is easy. First thing you need to do is to select all the keyframes for which you want to modify the speed. Selected keyframes will be highlighted in blue. Make sure you don't leave any keyframes behind as this will not lead to the intended result. Once all the keyframes have been selected by clicking the mouse and dragging, move the cursor all the way to the last keyframe.

Now, while pressing down the Alt key, click on the last keyframe and drag it out (if you want to prolong the effect). All the keyframes will stretch out over their respective properties' time frame in the apt proportion thereby producing a very smooth extension of the transition.

Similarly, if you want to contract the effect, select all the keyframes and while holding down Alt, push the final keyframe in with your mouse.

It's interesting to note that while selecting all keyframes and modifying with the final keyframe, the starting keyframe acts as an anchor and conversely, while moving with the initial keyframes, the final keyframe acts as an anchor

These features along with the easing options, add a huge load of dynamism to animating in After Effects.